
Problem 3 (10 points). Welsh

The following data comes from Welsh, which is a Celtic language spoken in Wales, in the United Kingdom by around half a million people. One way that linguists like to classify the grammar of a language is in terms of the basic word order of subject, object, and verb. For instance, both English and Chinese are SVO languages (subject, verb, object) as seen in sentences such as:

I (S) read (V) books (O)

我 (S) 看 (V) 書 (O)

Study the sentences from Welsh below and their English translations.

	Welsh	English
1	Gwelodd Rhiannon ddraig.	‘Rhiannon saw a dragon.’
2	Mae Rhiannon wedi gweld draig.	‘Rhiannon has seen a dragon.’
3	Dw i ’n credu <u>yr</u> hoffai Gwyn fynd adre.	‘I believe Gwyn would like to go home.’
4	Dw i ’n gwybod <u>y</u> bydd Sioned yn canu.	‘I know Sioned will be singing.’
5	y dyn <u>a</u> welais i.	‘the man that I saw’
6	y llyfr <u>y</u> mae Gwyn yn ei ddarllen.	‘the book that Gwyn is reading’
7	Rhiannon <u>a</u> welodd ddraig.	‘It was Rhiannon that saw a dragon.’
8	Draig <u>a</u> welodd Rhiannon.	‘It was a dragon that Rhiannon saw.’

(1) What is the basic word order of Welsh? Explain your reasoning.

(2) Can you find and list all forms of the verb ‘see’ in the above sentences? Can you explain why they are different in each case?

(3) Look at the short words that are underlined in the examples. What do you think is the meaning or the purpose of these words?

Reference:

Borsley, R.D., Tallerman, M., & Willis, D. (2007). *The Syntax of Welsh*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.